

The time away from work may also reap some benefits that are a little more difficult to measure, including: an improvement in mental or physical health, enhancement of family relationships, and the communication of healthy boundaries to your boss and coworkers. Some may even find that it is a perfect opportunity to earn some extra cash beyond their vacation pay by doing odd jobs or participating in a temporary or contract position!

If you've been putting off those much-needed vacation days for fear of falling behind at work, consider the monetary gain of getting away for a bit. You worked hard for those days. Why not put them to work for you?

— **Linsey Knerl**

4 Secrets to Eating Cheaply while Traveling Abroad

I've been on the go a lot this last year, but no matter which city I was in, I still had to eat. I learned a few tricks to

keep myself comfortably fed on the go, without breaking the bank.

1. Pack a lunch

I bet you looked at "pack a lunch" and laughed. How can you pack a lunch while living out of a suitcase or staying in a motel room? But there are grocery stores everywhere, from Cardiff, Wales, to Tel Aviv, Israel, and most places even have cheap little markets with fresh produce. Even if you'll only be around for a few days, toss a couple of staples in your backpack and skip restaurants altogether! As long as you don't pick anything that needs refrigerating, you're safe.

I had the opportunity to go to Spain with my grandparents when I was a kid. I had two years of introductory Spanish, but, between the three of us, that was it. My grandfather managed to find a bakery in every town we stopped in, and could usually find a farmer's market of some sort, too. We ate bread and apples, often with some cheese, and I don't think I ever got bored of it. It wasn't even an issue of frugality—we could just see more if we weren't stopping for a meal every couple of hours.

2. Make friends

I've managed to get myself invited along on cheap evenings out with